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CMAS-resistant barrier coatings

Abstract

An example article includes a substrate and a barrier coating on the substrate. The barrier coating includes a matrix including a rare-earth disilicate extending from an inner interface facing the substrate to an outer surface opposite the inner interface. The barrier coating includes a graded volumetric distribution of rare-earth oxide rich (REO-rich) phase regions in the matrix along a direction from the inner interface to the outer surface. The graded volumetric distribution defines a first volumetric density of the REO-rich phase regions at a first region of the matrix adjacent the outer surface. The graded volumetric distribution defines a second volumetric density of the REO-rich phase regions at a second region of the matrix adjacent the inner surface. The second volumetric density is different from the first volumetric density. An example technique includes forming the barrier coating on the substrate of a component.

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Background/Summary

(1) This application is a divisional filing of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/657,504, filed 18 Oct. 2019, which claims the benefit of U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 62/747,535, filed Oct. 18, 2018, U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 62/796,977, filed Jan. 25, 2019, and U.S. Provisional Application Ser. No. 62/876,272, filed Jul. 19, 2019, the entire contents of each which are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The disclosure relates to barrier coatings (EBCs), in particular, CMAS-resistant barrier coatings used for high temperature components.

BACKGROUND

(2) High temperature components such as engines face increasing performance demands at higher temperatures. Under certain operating conditions, siliceous materials such as airborne dust, sand, fly ash, volcanic dust, concrete dust, and fuel residue ingested into a high temperature component may accumulate on certain hot surfaces, for example, on blade, vanes, combustion tiles and turbine segments. These materials may fuse and melt when exposed to high temperatures, for example, temperatures above 1240° C., depending on the composition of the deposited materials. calcium-magnesium-alumino-silicate (CMAS), is the general name given to these molten deposits, as the predominant oxides are Calcia (CaO), Magnesia (MgO), Alumina (Al.sub.2O.sub.3) and Silica (SiO.sub.2).

(3) Engine components may be coated with one or more barrier layers to provide protection against thermal flux, erosion, and/or environmental contamination, for example, by reducing or preventing CMAS formation, migration, or infiltration.

SUMMARY

(4) The disclosure describes example barrier coatings, for example, environmental barrier coatings (EBCs), thermal barrier coatings (TBCs), or abradable coatings, and techniques and systems for manufacturing barrier coatings.

(5) In some examples, the disclosure describes an example article including a substrate and a barrier coating on the substrate. The barrier coating includes a matrix including a rare-earth disilicate extending from an inner interface facing the substrate to an outer surface opposite the inner interface. The barrier coating includes a graded volumetric distribution of rare-earth oxide rich (REO-rich) phase regions in the matrix along a direction from the inner interface to the outer surface. The graded volumetric distribution defines a first volumetric density of the REO-rich phase regions at a first region of the matrix adjacent the outer surface. The graded volumetric distribution defines a second volumetric density of the REO-rich phase regions at a second region of the matrix adjacent the inner surface. The second volumetric density is different from the first volumetric density.

(6) In some examples, the disclosure describes an example technique including forming a barrier coating adjacent a substrate of a component. The barrier coating includes a matrix including a rare-earth disilicate extending from an inner interface facing the substrate to an outer surface opposite the inner interface. The barrier coating includes a graded volumetric distribution of rare-earth oxide rich (REO-rich) phase regions in the matrix along a direction from the inner interface to the outer surface. The graded volumetric distribution defines a first volumetric density of the REO-rich phase regions at a first region of the matrix adjacent the outer surface. The graded volumetric distribution defines a second volumetric density of the REO-rich phase regions at a second region of the matrix adjacent the inner surface. The second volumetric density is different from the first volumetric density.

(7) The details of one or more examples are set forth in the accompanying drawings and the description below. Other features, objects, and advantages will be apparent from the description and drawings, and from the claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1A is a conceptual cross-sectional view of an example article including an example barrier coating on a substrate of a component, where the barrier coating has a higher volumetric density of rare-earth oxide-rich phase regions in a first region nearer an outer surface of the barrier coating than in a second region nearer the substrate.

(2) FIG. 1B is a conceptual cross-sectional magnified view of the article of FIG. 1A illustrating

example bands defined by rare-earth oxide-rich phase regions.

(3) FIG. 2 is a conceptual cross-sectional view of an example article including an example barrier coating adjacent a substrate of a component, where the barrier coating has a higher volumetric density of rare-earth oxide-rich phase regions in a second region nearer the substrate than in a first region nearer an outer surface of the barrier coating.

(4) FIG. 3 is a chart illustrating a phase diagram of an ytterbia-silica system.

(5) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram illustrating an example technique for forming a barrier coating in accordance with this disclosure.

(6) FIG. 5 is a micrograph showing a cross-section of an example barrier coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix and ytterbia-rich bands within the ytterbium disilicate matrix.

(7) FIG. 6 is a micrograph showing a cross-section of an example barrier coating including a porous ytterbium disilicate matrix and ytterbia-rich bands within the ytterbium disilicate matrix, adjacent a substrate.

(8) FIG. 7A is a micrograph showing a cross-section of an initial coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix.

(9) FIG. 7B is a micrograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. 7A after heat treatment.

(10) FIG. 7C is a micrograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. 7B after steam exposure.

(11) FIG. 8A is a micrograph showing a cross-section of an initial coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix and ytterbia-rich bands within the ytterbium disilicate matrix.

(12) FIG. 8B is a micrograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. 8A after heat treatment.

(13) FIG. 8C is a micrograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. 8B after steam exposure.

(14) FIG. 9 is a chart showing infiltration depth of CMAS over time for ytterbium disilicate (YbDS) and ytterbium monosilicate (YbMS).

(15) FIG. 10 is a micrograph illustrating an example in which ytterbium monosilicate powder was sufficiently large that the REO-rich regions deposited as “splats” in a ytterbium disilicate matrix as part of an spark plasma sintering process.

(16) FIG. 11 is a micrograph illustrating an example in which ytterbium monosilicate powder was ball-milled to form a finer dispersion of ytterbium monosilicate within a ytterbium disilicate matrix.

(17) FIGS. 12A-12D illustrate results of samples including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. %, 20 vol. %, and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate “splats” after being exposed to a model of CMAS having a molar composition of $\text{Ca}_{0.33}\text{Mg}_{0.9}\text{Al}_{0.13}\text{Si}_{0.45}$ at 1300°C . for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace.

(18) FIG. 13 is a plot of infiltration depth of CMAS into samples including ytterbium disilicate matrix and ytterbium monosilicate splats.

(19) FIG. 14 is a micrograph illustrating an example of microstructure of a sample including 20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, after exposure to a CMAS model at 1300°C . for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace.

(20) FIGS. 15A-15C illustrate results of samples including 0 vol. %, 20 vol. %, and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate fine particulates in ytterbium disilicate after exposure to a CMAS model at 1300°C . for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace.

(21) FIGS. 16A-16E are micrographs illustrating results of samples including about 3.24 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 9.20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 12.37 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 19.20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, and about 50.43 vol. wt. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, respectively, after CMAS exposure.

(22) FIGS. 17A-17P are magnified views of portions of some of the samples shown in FIGS. 16A-16E.

(23) FIG. 18A is an image illustrating how CMAS-infiltration depth was calculated for the samples shown in FIGS. 17B-17P.

(24) FIG. 18B is a plot of CMAS infiltration depth versus ytterbium monosilicate content for the conditions shown in FIGS. 17B-17P.

(25) FIG. 19 is a micrograph of an example ytterbium oxide powder.

(26) FIG. 20 is a micrograph of a sample formed from a powder including 20 vol. % ytterbium oxide coarse particles and a balance ytterbium disilicate.

(27) FIG. 21 is a micrograph of a sample formed from a powder including 20 vol. % ytterbium oxide fine particles and a balance ytterbium disilicate.

(28) FIGS. 22-24 are micrographs illustrating samples formed from a powder including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. % and 20 vol. % ytterbium oxide coarse particles and a balance ytterbium disilicate, after exposure to a CMAS model at 1300° C. for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace.

(29) FIG. 25 is a magnified view of the sample shown in FIG. 24.

(30) FIGS. 26-28 are micrographs illustrating samples formed from a powder including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. % and 20 vol. % ytterbium oxide fine particles and a balance ytterbium disilicate, after exposure to a CMAS model at 1300° C. for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace.

(31) FIG. 29 is a magnified view of the sample shown in FIG. 27.

(32) FIG. 30 is a magnified view of the sample shown in FIG. 28.

(33) FIGS. 31A-31F are micrographs illustrating samples formed with different layer combinations before and after CMAS exposure.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(34) The disclosure generally describes example barrier coatings, for example, environmental barrier coatings (EBCs), thermal barrier coatings (TBCs), or abradable coatings, and techniques for manufacturing barrier coatings. Barrier coatings according to the disclosure may include a matrix including at least one rare-earth disilicate, and a graded distribution of rare-earth oxide (REO)-rich phase regions in the matrix. Barrier coatings according to the disclosure may be useful in high-temperature applications, for example, as EBCs, TBCs, abradable coatings, or combinations thereof. Incorporating REO-rich phase regions with graded distributed in a rare-earth disilicate matrix may promote crack healing after heat treatment, and the coating may be more hermetic to resist ingress of oxidant species and CMAS, may improve water vapor resistance by reducing surface recession/volatilization rate, may improve CMAS resistance by reaction with SiO_2 in a melt, forming a rare-earth disilicate seal inhibiting further penetration of CMAS, or combinations thereof. In some examples, REO rich phases may react with CMAS to form stable products that slow the reaction/infiltration/penetration rate of CMAS (e.g. rare-earth disilicate, apatite $\{\text{Ca}_{1.5}\text{RE}_{0.5}(\text{SiO}_4)_2\}$, diopside $\{\text{Ca}(\text{Mg},\text{Al})[(\text{Si},\text{Al})_2\text{O}_6]\}$ and garnet $\{\text{RE}_3\text{Mg}_2\text{Si}_5\text{O}_{24}\}$).

(35) Thus, in some examples, barrier coatings according to the disclosure may allow high-temperature components to more safely operate in relatively higher temperature, steamy, or dusty environments, and may provide better coating strength, better resistance to oxidation, water vapor, and CMAS attack, or combinations thereof.

(36) In some examples, REO-rich phase regions may define bands in predetermined locations within the matrix. After heat treatment, the bands of REO-rich phase regions (for example Yb_2O_3 rich phase regions) may help heal the cracks. However, the total amount of REO-rich phase may be controlled to certain level as excessive REO-rich phase content in the coating may promote the formation of through thickness segmented cracks due to coefficient of thermal expansion mismatch between REO-rich phase and rare-earth disilicate. The REO-rich phase regions may also exhibit a greater resistance to reaction with water vapor (e.g., a lower reaction rate with water vapor) than the rare earth disilicate matrix. In some examples, distributing a higher

volumetric distribution of REO-rich phases adjacent an outer surface of the barrier coating (away from the substrate) may provide better water vapor resistance to the barrier coating as a whole.

(37) In some examples, the REO-rich phase regions include rare-earth oxide in excess of stoichiometric rare-earth disilicate. In some examples, the REO-rich phase regions include rare-earth oxide in excess of stoichiometric rare-earth monosilicate.

(38) In some examples, the REO-rich phase regions, for example, in bands, may decompose upon interaction with CMAS, dispersing REO precipitates (for example, Yb.sub.2O.sub.3 precipitates) into the rare earth disilicate (for example, ytterbium disilicate) matrix. The precipitates may then react with SiO.sub.2 in the CMAS melt, forming a rare-earth disilicate, which may seal the barrier coating and reduce or inhibit further penetration of CMAS into the barrier coating. The barrier coating may also form an inter-diffusion zone to provide a supply of REO precipitates (e.g., from portions of the barrier coating nearer the substrate), while the unaffected regions of the barrier coating may act as a reservoir for the REO. Thus, the barrier coating may resist or arrest CMAS infiltration through the barrier coating and restrict CMAS effects to only an outer region of the barrier coating, protecting the underlying substrate.

(39) FIG. 1A is a conceptual cross-sectional view of an example article **10** including an example barrier coating **11** on a substrate **12** of a component, where barrier coating **11** has a higher volumetric density of rare-earth oxide-rich phase regions in a first region nearer an outer surface of barrier coating **11** than in a second region nearer substrate **12**.

(40) The component may be a high-temperature component, for example, an industrial, automotive, or aeronautical component. In some examples, the component includes a gas turbine engine component, or the like. Substrate **12** may include at least one of a metal, alloy, or a ceramic, for example, a ceramic matrix composite (CMC). Barrier coating **11** may protect substrate **12** from an operating environment of component **12**. For example, barrier coating **11** may protect substrate **12** from thermal incursions, or from external contaminants or species. In some examples, barrier coating **11** may include an EBC, a TBC, an abradable coating, or the like, or may exhibit combinations of functions corresponding to one or more of an abradable coating, an EBC, or a TBC.

(41) Substrate **12** and barrier coating **11** each possess a respective coefficient of thermal expansion (CTE). The CTE of barrier coating **11** may be controlled based on the volumetric density and volumetric distribution of rare-earth oxide rich phases in one or more regions of barrier coating **11**, as described elsewhere in the disclosure. As such, the CTE of barrier coating **11** may vary within barrier coating **11**. In some examples, barrier coating **11**, or at least a portion of barrier coating **11** adjacent to substrate **12**, may exhibit a CTE that is the same as, or similar to that of substrate **12**, so that barrier coating **11** and substrate **12** exhibit substantially similar thermal contraction or expansion. In some examples, the CTE of both substrate **12** and a region of barrier coating **11** adjacent substrate **12** may be less than $7 \times 10^{-6}/^{\circ}\text{C}$., or less than $6.5 \times 10^{-6}/^{\circ}\text{C}$., or less than $6 \times 10^{-6}/^{\circ}\text{C}$., or less than $5.5 \times 10^{-6}/^{\circ}\text{C}$., or about $5 \times 10^{-6}/^{\circ}\text{C}$. In some examples, the substrate **12** and a region of barrier coating **11** may differ by less than 20%, or less than 10%, or less than 5%. This may reduce or substantially eliminate stress caused by differential thermal expansion of substrate **12** and barrier coating **11** at the interface of substrate **12** and barrier coating **11** when substrate **12** and barrier coating **11** are heated and cooled. In this way, the integrity of barrier coating **11** may be maintained, and separation, cracking, or spallation of barrier coating **11** may be reduced or prevented, for example, at an interfacial region of barrier coating **11** and substrate **12**. In some examples, article **10** further includes a bond coat applied to at least a portion of substrate **12**, and barrier coating **11** is applied to or formed on the bond coat (not shown). Thus, the bond coat may promote adherence or retention of barrier coating **11** on substrate **12**. The bond coat may include at least one metal, metalloid, alloy, ceramics, and mixtures or combinations thereof. In some examples, the bond coat includes elemental silicon.

(42) Barrier coating **11** includes a matrix **14** extending from an inner interface **16** to an outer

surface **18** opposite inner interface **16**. Inner interface **16** faces substrate **12** of the component, and may directly contact substrate **12** or another intermediate coating layer, such as a bond coat. Barrier coating **11** defines a coating thickness along a direction (represented by arrow “D” in FIG. **1A**) from outer surface **18** to inner interface **16**. Matrix **14** defines a first region **14A** adjacent outer surface **18**, and having a first thickness $T_{\text{sub.1}}$. Matrix **14** defines a second region **14B** adjacent inner interface **16**, and having a second thickness $T_{\text{sub.2}}$. In some examples, matrix **14** also may define a third region **14C** between first region **14A** and second region **14B**, and having a third thickness $T_{\text{sub.3}}$. All of the thicknesses $T_{\text{sub.1}}$, $T_{\text{sub.2}}$, and $T_{\text{sub.3}}$ are defined along the direction D. Thus, the total coating thickness of barrier coating **11** equals $T_{\text{sub.1}} + T_{\text{sub.2}} + T_{\text{sub.3}}$. Any of $T_{\text{sub.1}}$, $T_{\text{sub.2}}$, or $T_{\text{sub.3}}$ may be any suitable fraction of coating thickness of barrier coating **11**. Thus, barrier coating **11**, first region **14A**, second region **14B**, and third region **14C** may have any suitable coating thickness. In some examples, the coating thickness of barrier coating **11** is between about 50 micrometers and about 500 micrometers. In some examples, second thickness $T_{\text{sub.2}}$ is about 50 micrometers, third thickness $T_{\text{sub.3}}$ is about 50 microns, and first thickness $T_{\text{sub.1}}$ is about 25 micrometers. In some examples, barrier coating **11** may omit third region **14C**, and matrix **14** may define only first region **14A** and second region **14B**. In such examples, $T_{\text{sub.3}} = 0$. In other examples, barrier coating **11** may include more than three regions arrayed in the direction D.

(43) One or both of $T_{\text{sub.1}}$ or $T_{\text{sub.2}}$ may be greater than a predetermined threshold. In some examples, a ratio of the first thickness $T_{\text{sub.1}}$ to the total thickness of barrier coating **11**, $T_{\text{sub.1}}/T_{\text{sub.T}}$, is greater than about 0.01, or greater than about 0.05, or greater than about 0.1, or greater than about 0.2. In some examples, a second ratio of the second thickness $T_{\text{sub.2}}$ to the coating thickness, $T_{\text{sub.2}}/T_{\text{sub.T}}$, is greater than about 0.01, or greater than about 0.05, or greater than about 0.1, or greater than about 0.2. The first ratio and the second ratio may be the same or different. In some examples, the sum of the first ratio and the second ratio is 1, i.e., the first and second regions define the total thickness of barrier coating **11**.

(44) Matrix **14** includes at least one rare-earth disilicate. In some examples, the rare-earth disilicate includes an ytterbium species. In some examples, the rare-earth disilicate includes ytterbium disilicate. In some examples, matrix **14** consists essentially of the rare-earth disilicate, for example, ytterbium disilicate. In addition to, or instead of, ytterbium silicate, matrix **14** may include one or more of scandium, yttrium, or lutetium silicates.

(45) FIG. **1B** is a conceptual cross-sectional magnified view of article **11** of FIG. **1A** including a plurality of rare-earth oxide (REO)-rich phase regions **20** defining example bands **22A** to **22E** in distributed in matrix **14**. Each REO-rich phase region of the plurality of REO-rich phase regions **20** is configured to disperse REO-rich precipitates into matrix **14** in response to reacting with calcia magnesia alumina-silicate (CMAS). In some examples, the REO-rich precipitates are configured to react with SiO_2 (for example, isolated SiO_2 , or an SiO_2 group in a compound or a species such as CMAS) to form a CMAS-resistant rare-earth disilicate seal. The plurality of REO-rich phase regions **20** may include a rare earth monosilicate and/or free rare earth oxide (i.e., rare earth oxide that is not present in a compound including another component). In some examples, the rare earth monosilicate and/or free rare earth oxide includes the same rare earth as matrix **14**. In other examples, the rare earth monosilicate and/or free rare earth oxide includes a different rare earth than matrix **14**.

(46) In some examples, the rare-earth disilicate of matrix **14** includes ytterbium disilicate, and the plurality of REO-rich phase regions **20** includes free ytterbium oxide (i.e., ytterbium oxide that is not present in a compound including another component). In some examples, the plurality of REO-rich phase regions **20** includes ytterbium monosilicate instead of or in addition to ytterbium oxide. In addition to, or instead of, ytterbium oxide and/or monosilicate, REO-rich phase regions **20** may include one or more of oxides and/or monosilicates of scandium, yttrium, or lutetium. In some examples, REO-rich phase regions **20** include rare-earth oxide in excess of stoichiometric rare-

earth disilicate. In some examples, REO-rich phase regions **20** include rare-earth oxide in excess of stoichiometric rare-earth monosilicate.

(47) Barrier coating **11** includes a graded volumetric distribution of REO-rich phase regions **20** in matrix **14** along direction D from outer surface **18** to inner interface **16**. Thus, REO-rich phase regions **20** are not uniformly distributed in matrix **14**. For example, REO-rich phase regions **20** may define a plurality of bands **22**, where bands **22** are regions of matrix **14** including a higher volume fraction of REO-rich phase regions **20** relative to immediately adjacent regions of matrix **14**. As shown in the working examples below, REO-rich phase regions **20** and/or bands may be visibly distinct from the surrounding regions of matrix **14** due to the higher volume fraction of REO-rich phases. In some examples, bands **22** may include spaced apart REO-rich phase regions **20**, so that at least some regions **20** are spaced apart from neighboring REO-rich phase regions **20**. In some examples, bands **22** may include abutting REO-rich phase regions **20**, so that at least some regions **20** abut neighboring REO-rich phase regions **20**. In some examples, one or more bands **22** may not include distinct regions **20**, and may instead themselves define continuous bands of REO-rich phase regions **20**.

(48) REO-rich phase regions **20** may define different spatial configurations constituting bands **22**. For example, a band **22A** may include a single layer of at least partly spaced REO-rich phase regions **20**. Band **22B** may include more than one layer, for example, two or more layers of REO-rich phase regions **20**. REO-rich phase regions **20** may be regular or irregular spheroidal or ellipsoidal regions, or have any other suitable shape. REO-rich phase regions **20** may have substantially similar sizes and shapes, as shown in bands **22A** and **22B**. In some examples, REO-rich phase regions **20** may include extended, elongated, or agglomerated regions. For example, band **22C** may include relatively larger, irregular, extended, or elongated regions **20**. Band **22D** includes both small and larger regions.

(49) While bands **22** may be substantially planar, bands **22** may be partially or completely non-planar. For example, one or more bands **22** may be partly planar, and partly non-planar. Band **22E** is a curved band defined by REO-rich phase regions **20** distributed along a curved region in matrix **14**. Thus, bands **22** may deviate from planarity, and have any suitable shape or follow any suitable contour, such as planar, undulating, zig-zag, corrugated, or curved, or combinations thereof.

(50) In some examples, REO-rich phase regions **20** may not be distributed in discernible bands, and may instead be distributed throughout matrix **14**, however, in a predetermined graded non-uniform distribution along the direction D. For example, REO-rich phase regions **20** may define an increasing or a decreasing volumetric distribution along direction D in matrix **14**.

(51) Thus, regardless of whether REO-rich phase regions **20** define bands **22**, the graded volumetric distribution of REO-rich phase regions **20** defines a first volumetric density of the plurality of REO-rich phase regions **20** within first region **14A** of matrix **14** adjacent outer surface **18**. Likewise, the graded volumetric distribution of REO-rich phase regions **20** defines a second volumetric density of the plurality of REO-rich phase regions **20** at second region **14B** of matrix **14** adjacent inner interface **16**. The second volumetric density of REO-rich phase regions **20** is different from the first volumetric density by at least predetermined threshold amount. The predetermined threshold amount may be a fraction of the first volumetric density of REO-rich phase regions **20**, for example, at least 0.05, or at least 0.1, or at least 0.2, or at least 0.3, or at least 0.4, or at least 0.5, or any other suitable fraction. In some examples, instead of a threshold difference between the second volumetric density and the first volumetric density, the second volumetric density of REO-rich phase regions **20** may exhibit a predetermined ratio relative to the first volumetric density. For example, the ratio of the second volumetric density of REO-rich phase regions **20** to the first volumetric density may be less than 10, less than 5, less than 1, less than 0.9, less than 0.8, less than 0.7, less than 0.6, less than 0.5, less than 0.4, less than 0.3, less than 0.2, or less than 0.1, or more than 0.1, more than 0.2, more than 0.3, more than 0.4, more than 0.5, more than 0.6, more than 0.7, more than 0.8, more than 0.9, more than 1, or more than 5, or more than

10.

(52) In some examples, the ratio of the second volumetric density of REO-rich phase regions **20** to the first volumetric density is less than 1. Thus, second region **14B** may have a lower volumetric distribution of REO-rich phase regions **20** than first region **14A**, as shown in FIG. **1A**. For example, second region **14B** may include less than 10% by volume of REO-rich phase regions **20**, third region **14C** may include between about 10% and about 30% by volume of REO-rich phase regions **20**, and first region **14A** includes more than about 30% by volume of REO-rich phase regions **20**. In some such examples, second thickness $T_{sub.2}$ is about 50 micrometers, third thickness $T_{sub.3}$ is about 50 micrometers, and first thickness $T_{sub.1}$ is about 25 micrometers. Providing a higher first volumetric density (near outer surface interface **18**) may resist CMAS incursion at first region **14A** itself, for example, by forming a rare-earth disilicate seal, as described elsewhere in the disclosure. Thus, substrate **12** and inner portions of barrier coating **11** may be protected from CMAS incursion, or incursion of other species or contaminants.

(53) In other examples, the ratio of the first volumetric density of REO-rich phase regions **20** to the second volumetric density is less than 1, as described with reference to FIG. **2**.

(54) FIG. **2** is a conceptual cross-sectional view of an example article **30** including an example barrier coating **31** adjacent substrate **12** of a component, where barrier coating **31** has a higher volumetric density of REO-rich phase regions **20** in second region **14B** than in first region **14A** nearer outer surface **18** of barrier coating **11**. In some examples, first region **14A** of barrier coating **31** may define a plurality of pores **24**. Plurality of pores **24** may include isolated pores, fluidically interconnected pores, or combinations thereof. In some such examples, CMAS or other contaminants may be permitted to migrate to a predetermined region, for example, to first region **14A**, or second region **14C**, but may be resisted from migrating past second region **14B**. Thus, second region **14B** may present a relatively dense, high REO-rich phase volumetric concentration region to resist CMAS or other contaminants from affecting substrate **12**. In some such examples, REO-rich phase regions **20** may not be present at first region **14A** or be present in a lower volumetric fraction than in second region **14B** to permit controlled abrasion at first region **14A**. For example, REO-rich phase regions **20** may resist abrasion, and reducing the volumetric distribution in first region **14A** may permit abrasion of at least first region **14A** of barrier coating **31**.

(55) Regardless of the distribution of REO-rich phase regions **20**, the relative volumetric proportion of rare-earth monosilicate (and or rare-earth oxide) to that of rare-earth disilicate in a region may influence the CTE in that region. For example, as the volumetric proportion of rare earth disilicate increases, the overall CTE may decrease. For example, a region with 10% by volume of Yb monosilicate and 90% by volume of Yb disilicate may exhibit an overall lower CTE of $5.0 \times 10^{-6}/^{\circ}\text{C}$., while a region with 90% by volume of Yb monosilicate and 10% by volume of Yb disilicate may exhibit an overall higher CTE of $7.2 \times 10^{-6}/^{\circ}\text{C}$. In some examples, reducing the overall CTE may result in the CTE of barrier coating **11** being closer to the CTE of substrate **12** at inner interface **16**, reducing thermal stresses at inner interface and promoting the retention of barrier coating **11** or **31** on substrate **12**.

(56) Properties, for example, physical, chemical, or mechanical properties, of REO-rich phase regions and their neighboring regions may depend on the composition of the REO-rich regions and their neighboring regions. The equilibrium phase compositions of systems including rare-earth oxides and silicates (monosilicates or disilicates) at different temperatures may be determined using a phase diagram.

(57) FIG. **3** is a chart illustrating a phase diagram of an ytterbia (ytterbium oxide)-silica (silicon oxide) system. As seen in the phase diagram of FIG. **3**, the line marked “A” represents a phase containing 50% by volume $\text{Yb}_{2}\text{Si}_{2}\text{O}_{7}$ —50% by volume $\text{Yb}_{2}\text{SiO}_{5}$, while the line marked “B” represents a 10% by volume $\text{Yb}_{2}\text{SiO}_{5}$ —90% by volume $\text{Yb}_{2}\text{Si}_{2}\text{O}_{7}$. The line marked B represents a phase with better coefficient of thermal expansion (CTE) compatibility with an ytterbium disilicate matrix, than the phase represented by

line A. In some examples, a Yb.sub.2O.sub.3 rich phase is a phase having between about 34 to 100 mol. % of Yb.sub.2O.sub.3 and balance mol. % SiO.sub.2 (e.g., at least about 10 vol. % rare earth monosilicate and/or free rare earth oxide, or at least about 20 vol. % rare earth monosilicate and/or free rare earth oxide, or at least about 30 vol. % rare earth monosilicate and/or free rare earth oxide).

(58) The estimated coefficient of thermal expansion (CTE) of phases including different concentrations of ytterbium monosilicate (YbMS) and ytterbium disilicate (YbDS) is given by TABLE 1.

(59) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 Vol % YbMS 10 20 30 40 50 60 70 80 90 Vol % 90 80 70 60 50 40 30 20 10 YbDS Estimated 5.0 5.3 5.5 5.8 6.1 6.4 6.7 6.9 7.2 Overall CTE ($\times 10^6/^{\circ}\text{C}$.)

(60) FIG. 4 is a flow diagram illustrating an example technique for forming a barrier coating in accordance with this disclosure. While the example technique of FIG. 4 is described with reference to article 10 of FIG. 1A, the example technique of FIG. 4 may be used to prepare any example articles according to the disclosure.

(61) The example technique of FIG. 4 optionally includes forming a bond coat on substrate 12 of the component (40). Forming the bond coat may include vapor deposition, spraying, or any suitable technique. The bond coat may include at least one metal, metalloid, alloy, ceramics, and mixtures or combinations thereof. In some examples, the bond coat includes elemental silicon. The bond coat may promote bonding or retention of subsequently deposited or applied layers, for example, barrier coatings, on substrate 12.

(62) The example technique of FIG. 4 includes forming barrier coating 14 on substrate 12 (42). The forming (42) may be performed directly on a surface defined by substrate 12, or on an intermediate layer or coating on substrate 12, for example, on a bond coat.

(63) The forming (42) may include one or more of vapor deposition, slurry deposition, electrophoretic deposition, or thermal spraying, for example, air plasma spray, low pressure plasma spray, suspension plasma spray, or high velocity oxy-fuel (HVOF) spraying. The concentration of REO-rich phase regions 20 in barrier coating 14 can be adjusted by controlling spray gun parameters, such as hydrogen flow rate, gun current, standoff distances, and feedstock powder morphologies and sizes. For example, first region 14A may be sprayed using high hydrogen flow, high gun current, long standoff distances, or combinations thereof; third region 14C may be sprayed using moderate hydrogen flow, moderate gun current, moderate standoff distances, or combinations thereof; second region 14B may be sprayed using low hydrogen flow, low gun current, short standoff distances, or combinations thereof. The forming (42) may include a continuous process without stopping the gun or may include multiple spray runs.

(64) In some examples, the forming (42) may include thermal spraying substantially pure (e.g., less than 5 vol. % trace phases of un-reacted rare earth oxide, rare earth monosilicate, silica, and alumina) rare earth disilicate feedstock material and controlling the thermal spray parameters (e.g., gun current and primary argon flow rates) to achieve the desired coating composition (e.g., REO-rich phase content) by volatilizing silica from the rare earth disilicate feedstock material. In other examples, the forming (42) may include thermal spraying feedstock material that includes rare earth disilicate and rare earth monosilicate and/or rare earth oxide. The thermal spray parameters may be controlled to achieve the desired coating composition (e.g., REO-rich phase content) by controlling an amount of silica volatilized from the feedstock material.

(65) A slurry may be deposited using painting, dip coating, spraying, or the like, followed by drying and sintering. The slurry particles may include the desired composition of the final coating, or may include precursors, such as Si-rich particles and/or rare earth oxide-rich particles, that react during the sintering process to form the coating with a desired composition, gradient, and the like.

(66) In some examples, the forming (42) includes blending powder with stoichiometric rare-earth disilicate (for example, ytterbium disilicate), stoichiometric rare-earth monosilicate (for example, ytterbium monosilicate), and/or stoichiometric rare-earth oxide (for example, ytterbium oxide) in a

predetermined ratio before spraying or slurry coating the blend. In some examples, the REO-rich phase regions **20** may be formed from “splats” of REO-rich powder deposited using thermal spraying. In other examples, the REO-rich phase regions **20** may be formed from fine particulates of REO-rich powder deposited using thermal spraying, e.g., by mixing ball-milled REO-rich powder with rare earth disilicate powder and depositing the mixture using vapor deposition or thermal spraying. Similarly, by selecting powder size and morphology used to form a slurry, the resulting microstructure of the coating may be controlled.

(67) In some examples, the forming (**42**) includes surface reaction or sol-gel infiltration.

EXAMPLES

Example 1

(68) FIG. **5** is a micrograph showing a cross-section of an example coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix and ytterbia-rich bands within the ytterbium disilicate matrix. The coating was deposited using an SG-100 gun (Praxair) and two types of Yb disilicate powders. The outer region was sprayed with agglomerated and sintered powder, the inner region was sprayed with fused and crushed powder. An inner region of the coating adjacent a substrate was dense with less Yb.sub.2O.sub.3-rich bands. An outer region of the coating away from the substrate was dense with more Yb.sub.2O.sub.3-rich bands.

Example 2

(69) FIG. **6** is a micrograph showing a cross-section of an example barrier coating including a porous ytterbium disilicate matrix and ytterbia-rich bands within the ytterbium disilicate matrix, adjacent a substrate. The coating was deposited using both an F4 MB gun (Oerlikon Medco) and an SG-100 gun (Praxair) with agglomerated and sintered Yb disilicate powder. Outer region was sprayed with the F4 MB gun and the inner region was sprayed with the SG-100 gun. An inner region of the coating adjacent a substrate was dense with low porosity and more Yb.sub.2O.sub.3-rich bands. An outer region of the coating away from the substrate was porous with less Yb.sub.2O.sub.3-rich bands.

Comparative Example 1

(70) A coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix but with limited amount of ytterbia-rich regions was prepared. The sample was heat treated, followed by exposure to steam. FIG. **7A** is a micrograph showing a cross-section of an initial coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix. FIG. **7B** is a micrograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. **7A** after heat treatment. FIG. **7C** is a micrograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. **7B** after steam exposure. Cracks initially present in the coating persisted or widened after the heat treatment and steam exposure.

Example 3

(71) A coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix and with ytterbia-rich phase region bands within the ytterbium disilicate matrix was prepared. The sample was heat treated, followed by exposure to steam. FIG. **8A** is a photograph showing a cross-section of an initial coating including an ytterbium disilicate matrix and ytterbia-rich bands within the ytterbium disilicate matrix. FIG. **8B** is a photograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. **8A** after heat treatment. FIG. **8C** is a photograph showing a cross-section of the coating of FIG. **8B** after steam exposure. Cracks initially present reduced or disappeared after the heat treatment and steam exposure.

Example 4

(72) The CMAS resistance of ytterbium disilicate coating was compared to that of ytterbium monosilicate coating. Spark plasma sintering pellets were prepared. FIG. **9** is a chart showing infiltration depth of CMAS over time for ytterbium disilicate (YbDS) and ytterbium monosilicate (YbMS). As seen in FIG. **9**, the infiltration depth of CMAS was significantly lower for YbMS, indicating better CMAS resistance.

Example 5

(73) Samples including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. %, 20 vol. %, and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a

balance ytterbium disilicate were depositing prepared using spark plasma sintering. FIG. 10 is a micrograph illustrating an example in which ytterbium monosilicate powder was sufficiently large that the REO-rich regions were formed as “splats” as part of the spark plasma sintering. In the example of FIG. 10, ytterbium monosilicate constituted about 20 vol. % of the sample. FIG. 11 is a micrograph illustrating an example in which ytterbium monosilicate powder was ball-milled to form a finer dispersion of ytterbium monosilicate within ytterbium disilicate. In the example of FIG. 11, ytterbium monosilicate constituted about 20 vol. % of the sample.

(74) The samples were then exposed to a model of CMAS having a molar composition of $\text{Ca}_{0.33}\text{Mg}_{0.9}\text{Al}_{0.13}\text{Si}_{0.45}$ at 1300° C. for up to 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace. FIGS. 12A-12D illustrate results of the samples including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. %, 20 vol. %, and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate “splats.” As shown in FIGS. 12C and 12D compared to FIGS. 12A and 12B, samples with 20 and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate exhibited improved resistance to CMAS attack. FIGS. 12A and 12B illustrate relatively large regions of increased porosity formed by CMAS attack, while FIGS. 12C and 12D illustrate unreacted CMAS glass 52, 54 on the surface of the freestanding sample and lower amounts of porosity due to reaction with CMAS. FIG. 13 is a plot of infiltration depth of CMAS into the samples similar to those of FIGS. 12A, 12C, and 12D as a function of time. As shown in FIG. 13, the depth of infiltration and the infiltration rate were lower for the samples including 20 vol. % and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate than for the sample including only ytterbium disilicate.

(75) FIG. 14 is a micrograph illustrating an example of microstructure of a sample including 20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, after exposure to the CMAS model at 1300° C. for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace. As shown in FIG. 13, CaO preferentially reacts with $\text{Yb}_{0.2}\text{SiO}_{0.5}$ and forms darker apatite at the surface and around the $\text{Yb}_{0.2}\text{SiO}_{0.5}$ splats.

(76) FIGS. 15A-15C are micrographs illustrating results of samples including 0 vol. %, 20 vol. %, and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate fine particulates after exposure to a CMAS model at 1300° C. for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace. As shown in FIGS. 15B and 15C compared to FIG. 15A, samples with 20 and 30 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate exhibited improved resistance to CMAS attack.

Example 6

(77) Coatings including about 3.24 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 9.20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 12.37 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 19.20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, and about 50.43 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate were deposited on respective graphite blocks using thermal spraying. Feedstock of the samples included pure ytterbium disilicate powder (less than 5 vol % trace phases of un-reacted $\text{Yb}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.3}$, $\text{Yb}_{0.2}\text{SiO}_{0.5}$, $\text{SiO}_{0.2}$, and $\text{Al}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.3}$). The gun current and primary argon flow rates were controlled to achieve the desired coating composition.

(78) Compositions were determined using quantitative XRD against samples with known ratios of ytterbium disilicate and ytterbium monosilicate.

(79) After spraying, the coatings were removed from the graphite blocks using a razor blade to leave a freestanding coating. The freestanding coatings were heat treated for 2 hours at about 1200° C. prior to CMAS resistance testing. Samples were tested for CMAS resistance by loading between about 20 mg/cm² and about 25 mg/cm² CMAS with a content of about 11.27 wt. % $\text{Al}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.3}$, about 29.47 wt. % CaO, about 7.75 wt. % MgO, about 50.45 wt. % $\text{SiO}_{0.2}$, about 0.06 wt. % $\text{Fe}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.3}$, about 0.45 wt. % $\text{ZrO}_{0.2}$, and a balance other components on each respective freestanding coating. The CMAS-loaded samples were heated at about 1300° C. and 1400° C. for about 8 hours and 96 hours.

(80) FIGS. 16A-16E are micrographs illustrating results of samples including about 3.24 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 9.20 vol. % ytterbium

monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 12.37 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, about 19.20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, and about 50.43 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate and a balance ytterbium disilicate, respectively, after CMAS exposure. FIGS. **16A-16E** show freestanding coatings **62, 72, 82, 92, and 102**, respectively. FIG. **16A** also shows reaction zone **64** formed by reaction of CMAS with freestanding coating **62**, while FIGS. **16B-16E** illustrate residual CMAS **74, 84, 94, and 104** on the surface of freestanding coatings **72, 82, 92, and 102**.

(81) FIGS. **17A-17P** are magnified views of portions of some of the samples shown in FIGS. **16A-16E**. As shown in FIG. **17A**, residual CMAS **112** remains on a surface of the sample. Apatite **114** formed from reaction between components of CMAS (e.g., CaO) and ytterbium monosilicate. Also visible in FIG. **17A** are regions of ytterbium monosilicate **116** and regions of ytterbium disilicate **118**.

(82) FIGS. **17B-17F** illustrate magnified view of a portion of samples including about 3.24 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate after exposure to different conditions. FIG. **17B** shows the sample prior to being exposed to CMAS. FIG. **17C** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 8 hours at 1300° C. FIG. **17D** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 96 hours at 1300° C. FIG. **17E** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 8 hours at 1400° C. FIG. **17F** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 96 hours at 1400° C.

(83) FIGS. **17G-17K** illustrate magnified view of a portion of samples including about 19.20 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate after exposure to different conditions. FIG. **17G** shows the sample prior to being exposed to CMAS. FIG. **17H** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 8 hours at 1300° C. FIG. **17I** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 96 hours at 1300° C. FIG. **17J** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 8 hours at 1400° C. FIG. **17K** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 96 hours at 1400° C.

(84) FIGS. **17L-17P** illustrate magnified view of a portion of samples including about 50.43 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate after exposure to different conditions. FIG. **17L** shows the sample prior to being exposed to CMAS. FIG. **17M** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 8 hours at 1300° C. FIG. **17N** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 96 hours at 1300° C. FIG. **17O** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 8 hours at 1400° C. FIG. **17P** shows the sample after being exposed to CMAS for 96 hours at 1400° C.

(85) FIG. **18A** is an image illustrating how CMAS-infiltration depth was calculated for the samples shown in FIGS. **17B-17P**. As shown in FIG. **18A**, an image of the sample prior to testing was aligned with an image of the coating after CMAS exposure testing such that the bottom surfaces of the samples were aligned. A depth of CMAS infiltration into the sample was then determined by measuring the lowest point of CMAS infiltration from an original height of the coating.

(86) FIG. **18B** is a plot of CMAS infiltration depth versus ytterbium monosilicate content for the conditions shown in FIGS. **17B-17P**. As shown in FIG. **18B**, increasing ytterbium monosilicate content generally reduced CMAS infiltration depth. For the sample including 3.24 vol. % ytterbium monosilicate heated at 1300° C. for 8 hours, the sample initially dissolved at a lower rate and swelled, which led to the small apparent CMAS infiltration depth.

Example 7

(87) Samples were formed from materials including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. %, and 20 vol. % ytterbium oxide and a balance ytterbium disilicate using spark plasma sintering. FIG. **19** is a micrograph of ytterbium oxide powder used to form the material. FIG. **20** is a micrograph illustrating an example in which ytterbium oxide powder was sufficiently large that the REO-rich regions formed as “splats” as part of the spark plasma sintering process. In the example of FIG. **20**, ytterbium oxide constituted about 20 vol. % of the sample. As shown in FIG. **20**, ytterbium oxide reacted with ytterbium disilicate in an equilibrium reaction to form ytterbium monosilicate at the interface between the ytterbium oxide “splats” and the ytterbium silicate. The extent of reaction was diffusion limited; the reaction did not proceed to completion prior to cooling of the sample.

(88) FIG. 21 is a micrograph illustrating an example in which ytterbium oxide powder was ball-milled to form a finer dispersion of ytterbium oxide within ytterbium disilicate. In the example of FIG. 21, ytterbium oxide constituted about 10 vol. % of the sample material. As shown in FIG. 21, substantially all the ytterbium oxide reacted to form ytterbium monosilicate in the sample after plasma spark sintering.

(89) The samples were then exposed to a model of CMAS having a molar composition of Ca.sub.33Mg.sub.9Al.sub.13Si.sub.45 at 1300° C. for up to 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace. FIGS. 22-24 illustrate results of the samples formed from materials including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. %, and 20 vol. % coarse ytterbium oxide powder. As seen in FIGS. 23 and 24, samples formed from materials having 10 vol. % and 20 vol. % coarse ytterbium oxide powder exhibited improved CMAS resistance compared to the sample formed from pure ytterbium disilicate, although the sample deposited from coating materials having 10 vol. % coarse ytterbium oxide powder had large ytterbium disilicate domains susceptible to CMAS attack.

(90) FIG. 25 is a magnified view of the sample shown in FIG. 24. As seen in FIG. 25, apatite formed at the interface between CMAS and the sample and reduced or substantially halted CMAS attack of the remainder of the sample.

(91) FIGS. 26-28 are micrographs illustrating samples formed from a material including 0 vol. %, 10 vol. % and 20 vol. % fine ytterbium oxide particles and a balance ytterbium disilicate, after exposure to a CMAS model at 1300° C. for about 96 hours in a stagnant air box furnace. As seen in FIGS. 27 and 28, samples formed from materials having 10 vol. % and 20 vol. % fine ytterbium oxide powder exhibited improved CMAS resistance compared to the sample formed from pure ytterbium disilicate.

(92) FIG. 29 is a magnified view of the sample shown in FIG. 27, and FIG. 30 is a magnified view of the sample shown in FIG. 28. As seen in FIGS. 29 and 30, apatite formed at the interface between CMAS and the sample and reduced or substantially halted CMAS attack of the remainder of the coating. Additionally, substantially no glass spreading was observed as in the examples formed from a fine mixture of ytterbium disilicate and ytterbium monosilicate.

Example 8

(93) FIGS. 31A-31F are micrographs illustrating samples formed with different layer combinations before and after CMAS exposure. FIGS. 31A-31C illustrate micrographs of samples with different coating architectures before exposure to CMAS. The layers had properties shown in Table 1.

(94) TABLE-US-00002 TABLE 1 Ytterbium Monosilicate Porosity Density content Label % g/mL Vol. % B 1.81 5.992 9.20 C 4.58 5.926 19.20 D 3.97 6.332 50.43

(95) The samples were exposed to CMAS at a loading of 1 mg/cm.² every 25 heating cycles (about 1.5 mg/cm.² for the sample shown in FIGS. 31C and 31F). Each heating cycle included heating at a temperature of about 1316° C. for about 1 hour. Each sample was exposed to a total of 50 heating cycles. As shown in FIGS. 31D-31F, the two-layer and three-layer samples shown in FIGS. 31E and 31F exhibited greater resistance to CMAS infiltration and shown the smaller CMAS infiltration depth compared to the one-layer sample shown in FIG. 31D.

(96) Various examples have been described. These and other examples are within the scope of the following claims.

Claims

1. A method comprising: forming a barrier coating on a substrate of a component, wherein the barrier coating comprises: a matrix comprising a rare-earth disilicate, the matrix extending from an inner interface facing the substrate to an outer surface opposite the inner interface; and a graded volumetric distribution of rare-earth oxide rich (REO-rich) phase regions in the matrix along a direction from the inner interface to the outer surface, wherein the REO-rich phase regions define bands in predetermined locations within the matrix, and wherein the matrix has a higher volumetric

density of the REO-rich phase regions in a first region nearer the outer surface than in a second region nearer the inner interface.

2. The method of claim 1, further comprising forming a bond coat on the substrate, and forming the barrier coating on the bond coat.

3. The method of claim 1, wherein the rare-earth disilicate comprises ytterbium disilicate, and wherein the forming the barrier coating comprises at least one of: thermally spraying a composition consisting essentially of ytterbium disilicate towards the substrate using thermal spray parameters selected to volatilize a selected amount of silica, thermally spraying a composition comprising ytterbium disilicate towards the substrate, thermally spraying a composition comprising ytterbium disilicate and at least one of ytterbium monosilicate or ytterbium oxide towards the substrate, depositing a composition comprising ytterbium disilicate and at least one of ytterbium monosilicate or ytterbium oxide from a slurry, depositing a composition consisting essentially of ytterbium disilicate from a slurry depositing a composition comprising ytterbium disilicate and at least one of ytterbium monosilicate or ytterbium oxide using a vapor deposition process, depositing a composition consisting essentially of ytterbium disilicate using a vapor deposition process, depositing a composition comprising ytterbium disilicate and at least one of ytterbium monosilicate or ytterbium oxide using an electrophoretic deposition process, or depositing a composition consisting essentially of ytterbium disilicate using an electrophoretic deposition process.

4. The method of claim 3, wherein the REO-rich phase regions comprise free ytterbium oxide, and wherein forming the barrier coating comprises controlling the thermal spraying to form at least one of ytterbium oxide or ytterbium monosilicate from ytterbium disilicate in the composition.

5. The method of claim 1, wherein the substrate is a substrate of a gas turbine engine component, and wherein the barrier coating comprises an environmental barrier coating.

6. The method of claim 1, wherein the matrix has a higher porosity in the first region nearer the outer surface than in the second region nearer the inner interface.

7. The method of claim 1, wherein the barrier coating defines a coating thickness along the direction from the outer surface to the inner interface, wherein the first region defines a first thickness along the direction, wherein the second region defines a second thickness along the direction, and wherein a ratio of the first thickness to the coating thickness is greater than 0.1, and wherein a ratio of the second thickness to the coating thickness is greater than 0.1.

8. The method of claim 7, wherein a sum of the ratio of the first thickness to the coating thickness and the ratio of the second thickness to the coating thickness is 1.

9. The method of claim 7, wherein the coating thickness is between 50 micrometers and 500 micrometers.

10. The method of claim 1, the second region defines a thickness of 50 microns in the direction from the outer surface to the inner interface, and wherein the first region defines a thickness of 25 microns in the direction from the outer surface to the inner interface.

11. The method of claim 1, wherein a third region between the second region and the first region comprises between 10% and 30% by volume of the REO-rich phase regions.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein the second region defines a thickness of 50 microns in the direction from the outer surface to the inner interface, wherein the third region defines a thickness of 50 microns in the direction from the outer surface to the inner interface, and wherein the first region defines a thickness of 25 microns in the direction from the outer surface to the inner interface.

13. The method of claim 1, wherein the matrix has a porosity comprising between 1.81% and 4.58%.

14. A method comprising: forming a barrier coating on a substrate of a component, wherein the barrier coating comprises: a matrix comprising a rare-earth disilicate, the matrix extending from an inner interface facing the substrate to an outer surface opposite the inner interface, the matrix further comprising: a first layer adjacent the inner interface comprising about 10% by volume

ytterbium monosilicate and about 90% by volume ytterbium disilicate, and wherein the first layer further comprises a porosity of 1.81%; and a second layer adjacent the outer surface comprising about 50% by volume ytterbium monosilicate and about 50% by volume ytterbium disilicate, and wherein the first layer further comprises a porosity of 3.97%; and wherein the barrier coating defines a coating thickness along a direction from the outer surface to the inner interface, wherein the second layer defines a first thickness along the direction, wherein the first layer defines a second thickness along the direction, and wherein a ratio of the first thickness to the coating thickness is greater than 0.1, and wherein a ratio of the second thickness to the coating thickness is greater than 0.1.
